AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

aidengcheney@gmail.com | 903-413-8083 | linkedin.com/in/aiden-cheney-/

FSAE REAR WHEEL HUB ASSEMBLY

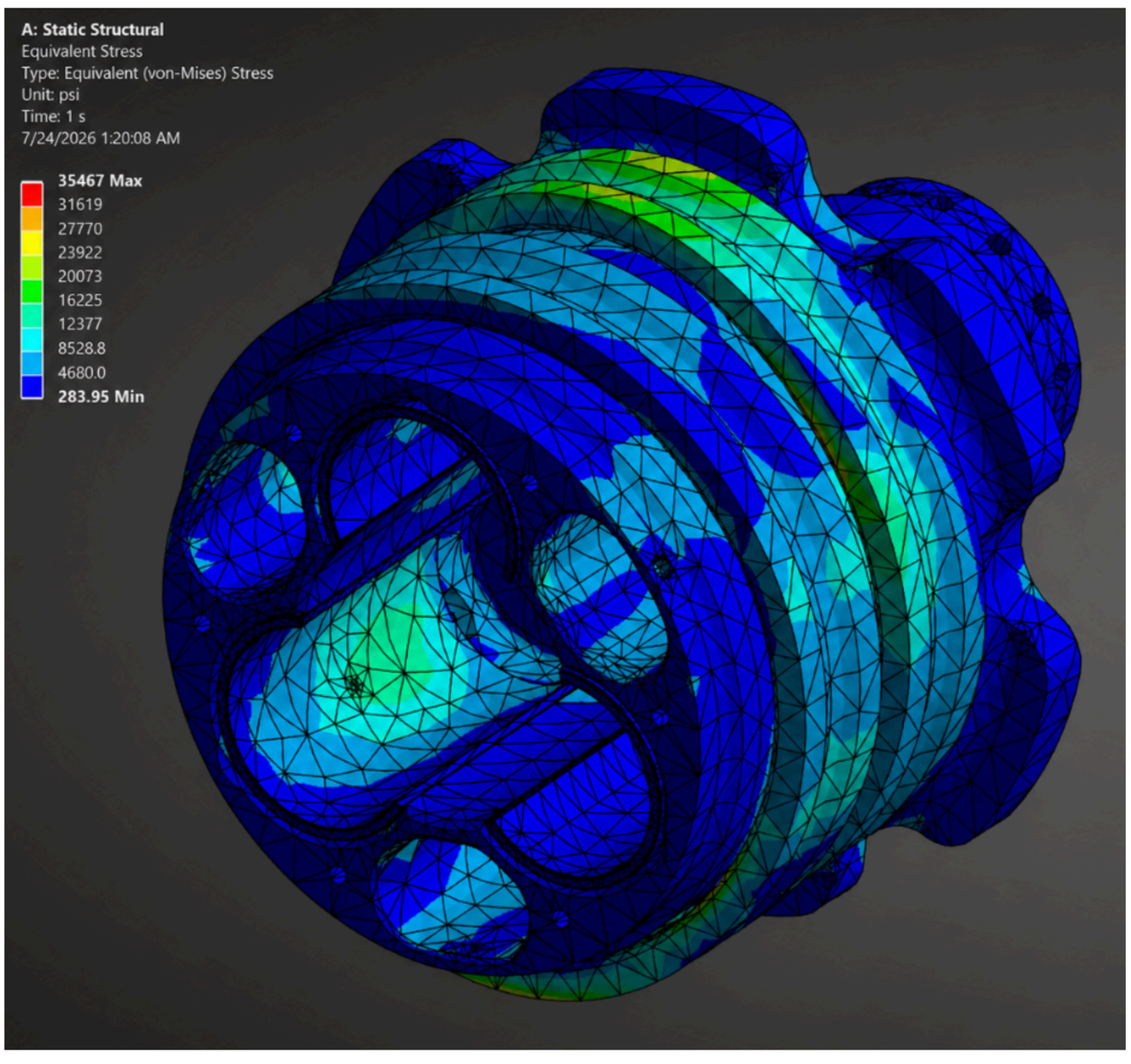
Longhorn Racing Electric | Aug–Dec 2025

Project Scope: Owned the complete development of a lightweight, high-stiffness rear wheel hub assembly from requirements and CAD through FEA, tolerance definition, machining, vehicle integration, and 600+ miles of on-car testing.

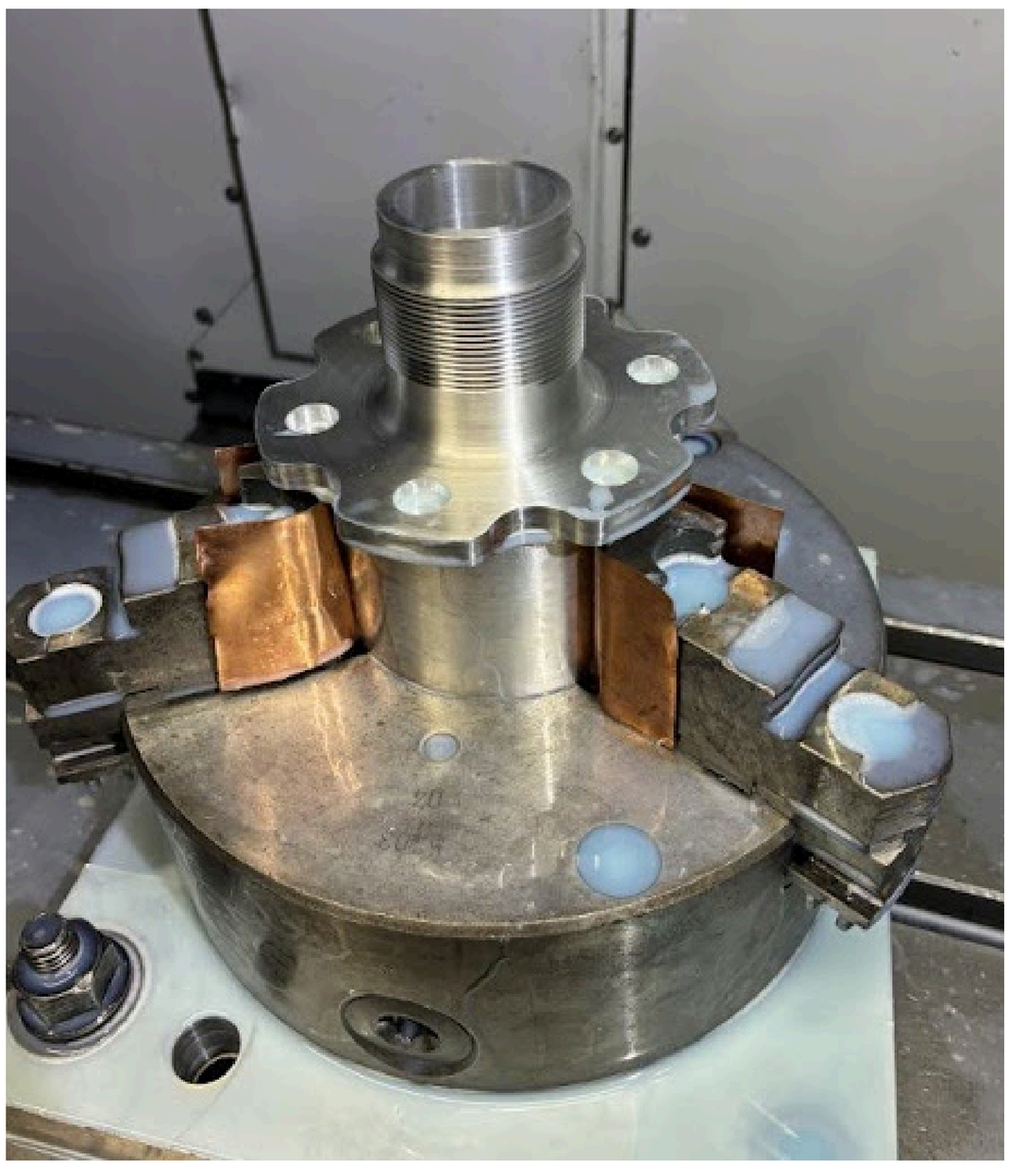
- Redistributed mass from FEA-confirmed low-stress regions (inner bore, hub-wheel interface) into shimmed tripod-bearing contact zone after first-iteration hotspots
- Checked a 500,000-cycle fatigue design target across four load cases using Miner’s rule, Marin-adjusted S–N data, and Goodman mean-stress correction
- Released ASME Y14.5 drawing: functional datums, press-fit reqs, worst-case tolerance stack
- 2 CNC setups, 1 re-fixture, full Fusion 360 CAM toolpath set

Metric	Result
Mass	1.31 → 1.12 lb (–14.5%)
FOS	2.06 (2g/2g/3g + braking torque)
Fatigue life	500,000 cycles (Miner's rule)
Validation	600+ on-car miles, no observed hub failures

Combined-load FEA | FOS 2.06



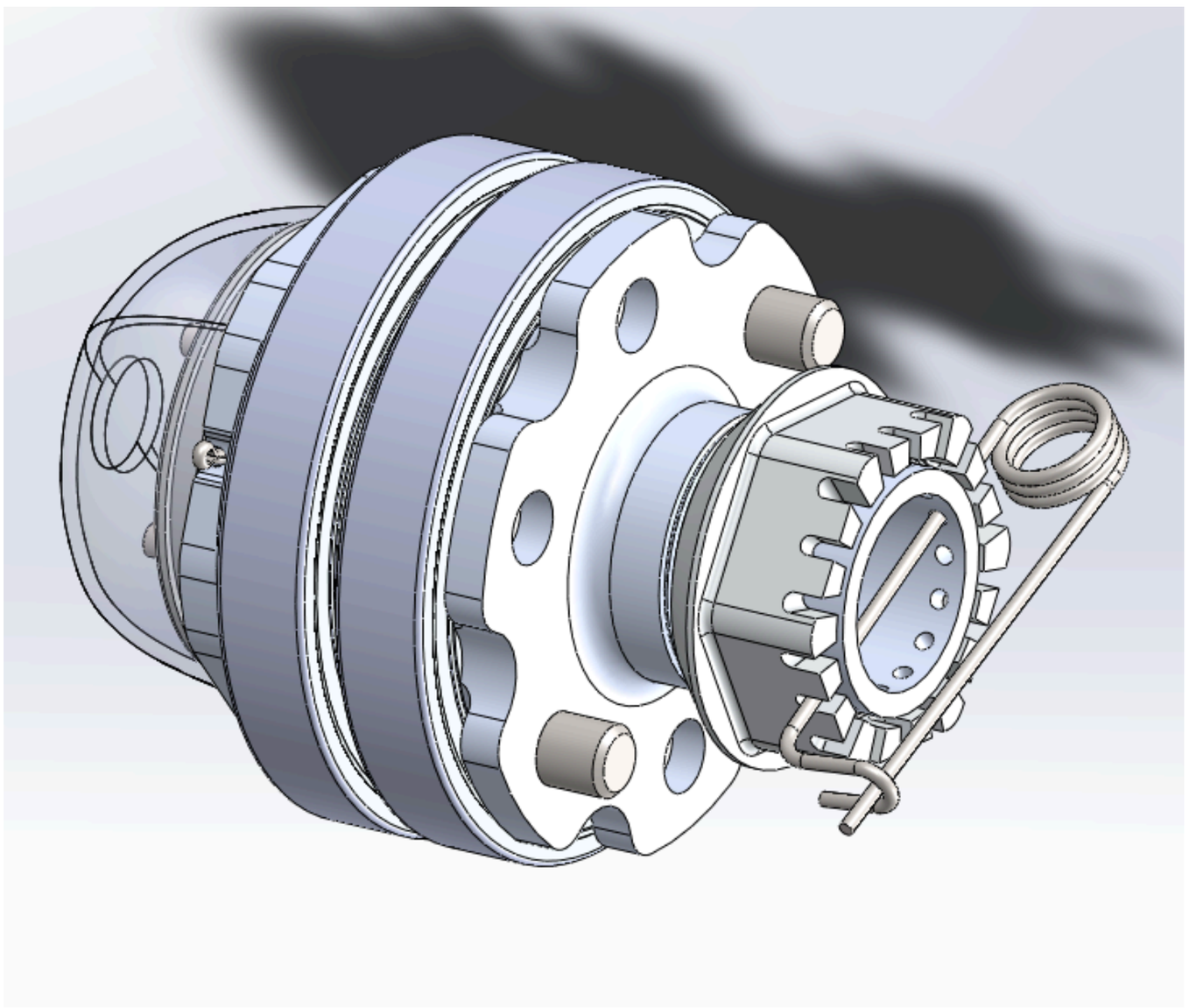
CNC machining — setup 2/2



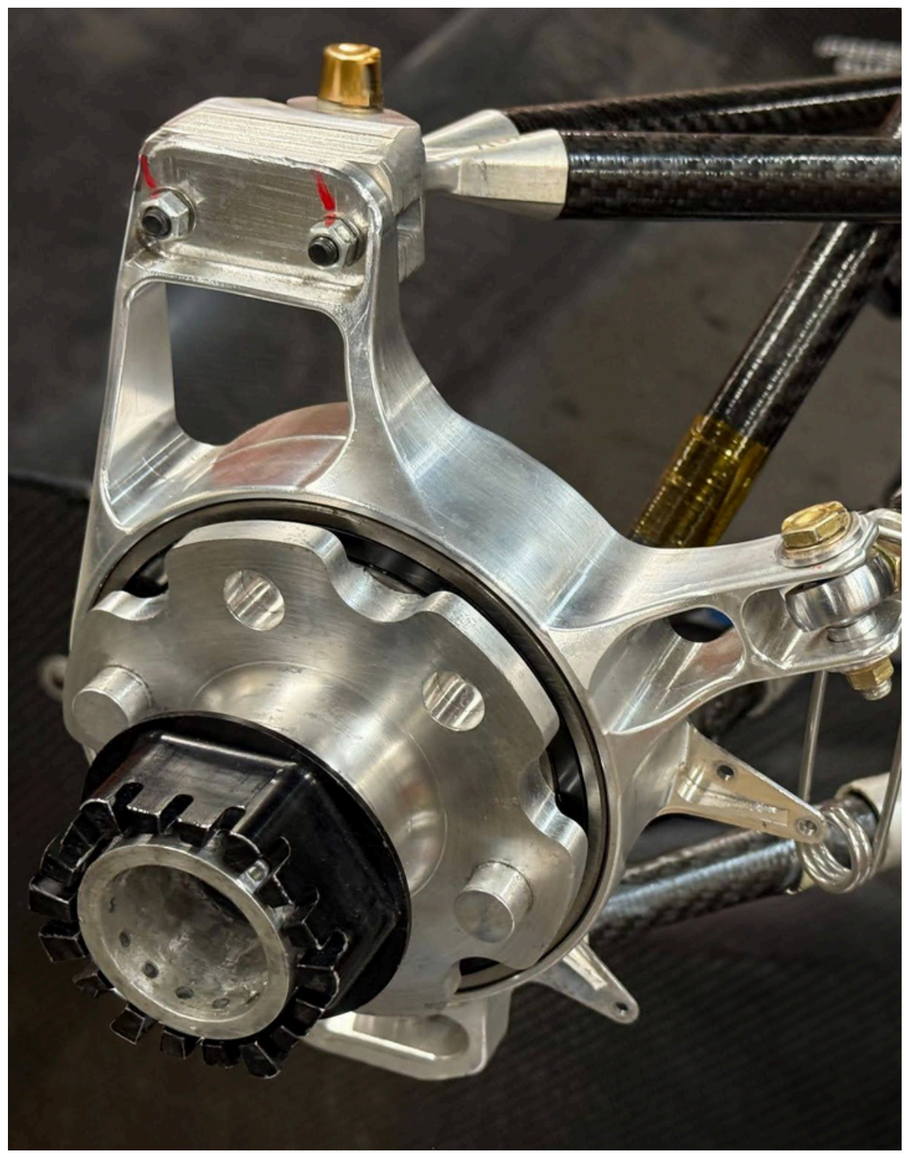
AIDEN CHENEY

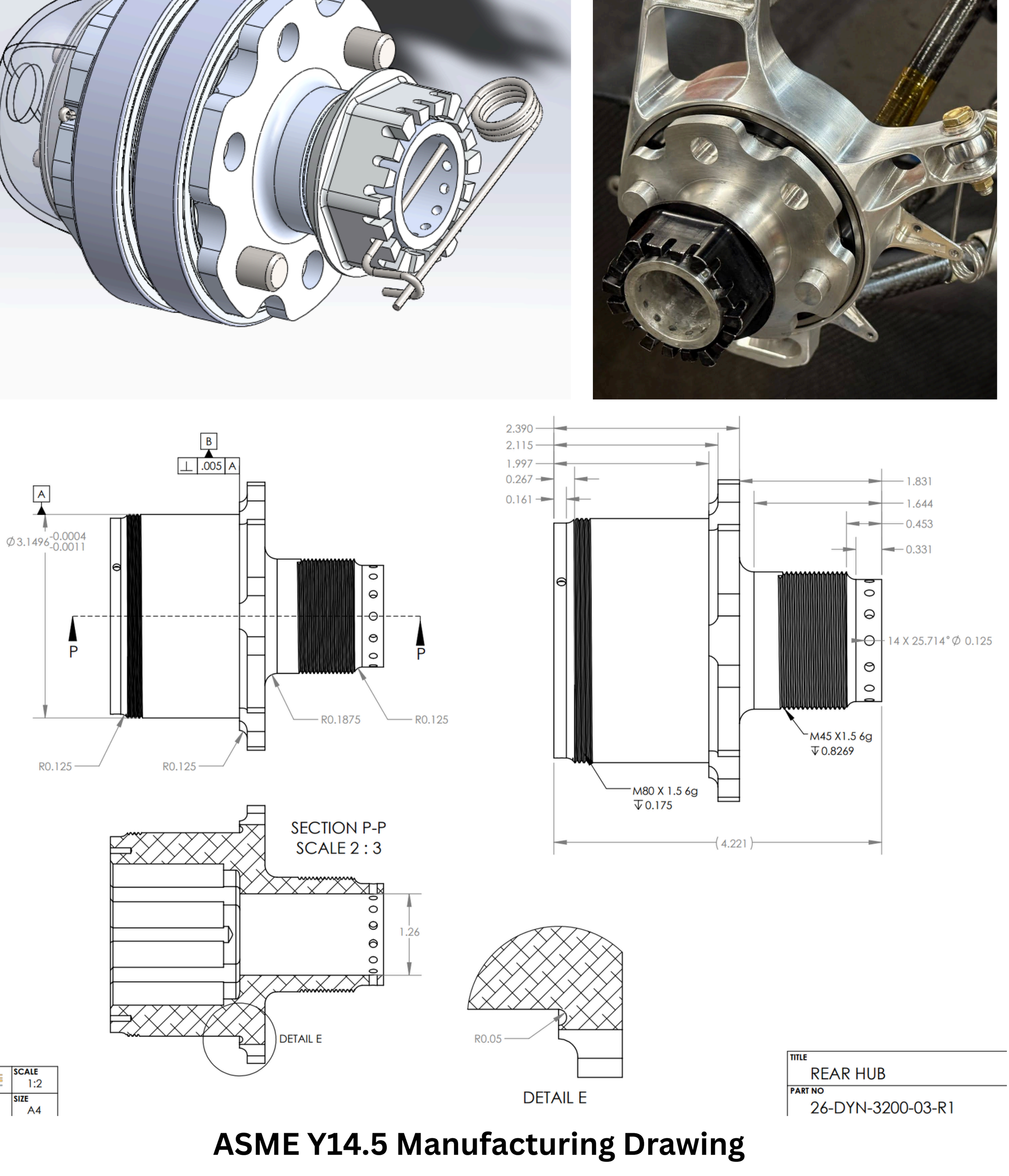
MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

Hub + bearing/preload assembly



Installed rear hub | 600+ miles





ASME Y14.5 Manufacturing Drawing

AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

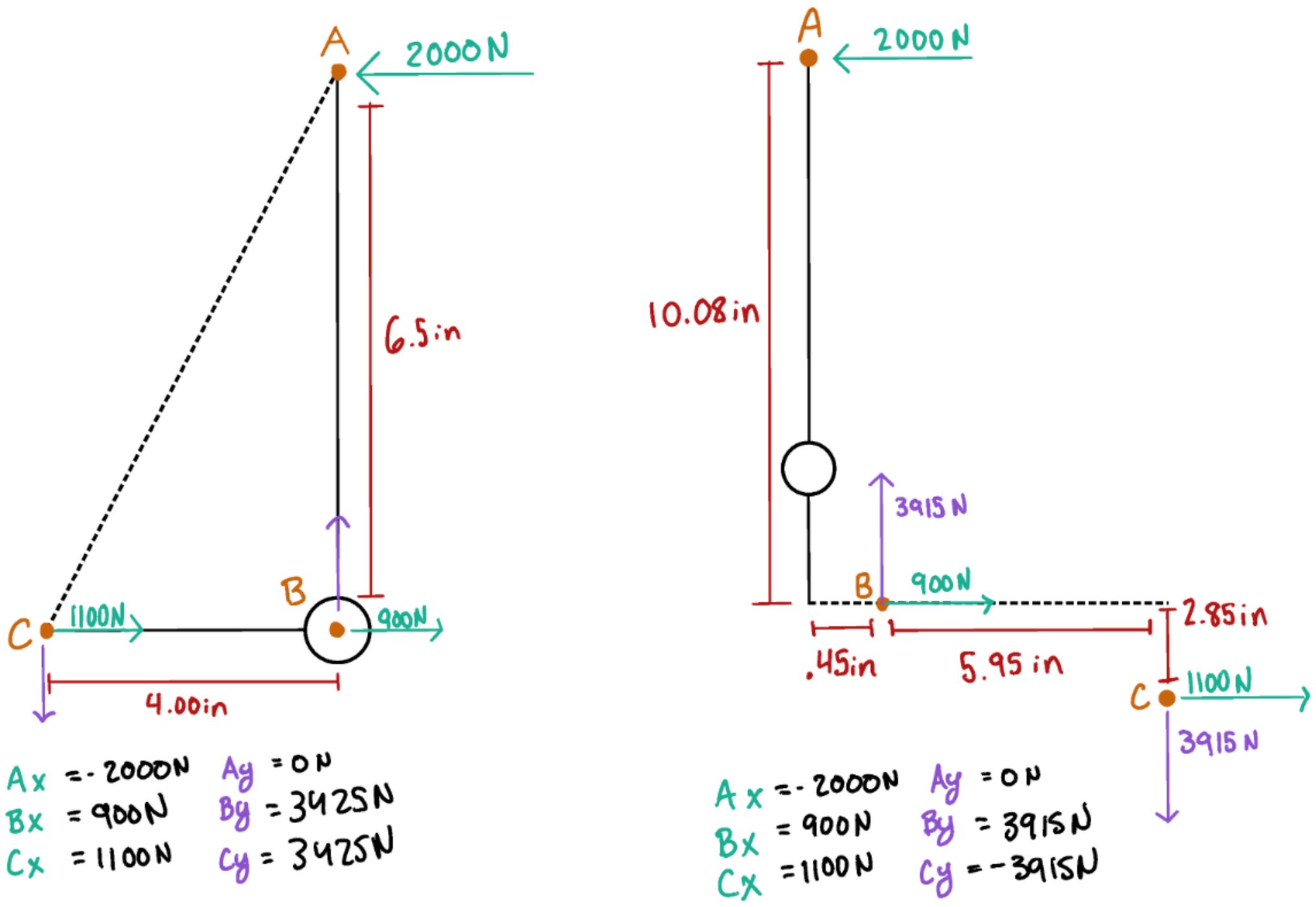
FSAE PEDAL BOX DEVELOPMENT

Longhorn Racing Electric | Aug 2026–Present

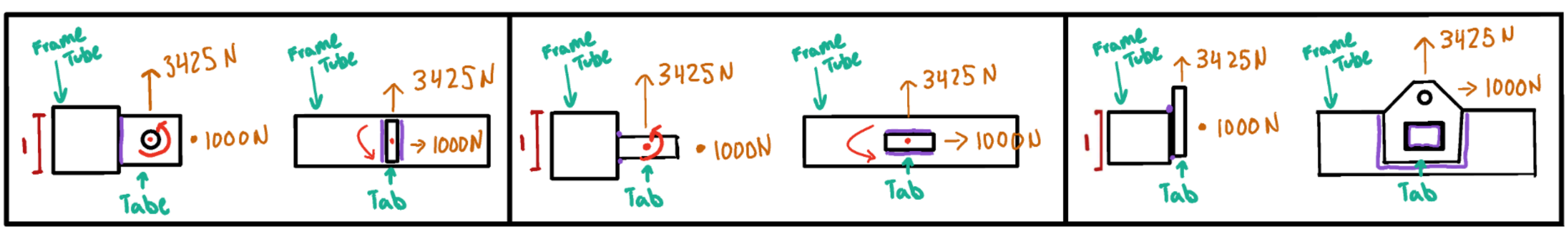
Project Scope: Own the requirements, architecture, and design of the team's pedal box, including hydraulic sizing, driver packaging, structural/load-path analysis, manufacturing, and validation.

- SolidWorks + Excel design study to solve pedal ratio, drove the vertical MC call
- Shrunk MC moment arm 10.08 → 6.5 in, cutting load and weight through the system
- FBD-driven tab study: reverse-engineered last year's loads, sized this year's tab and weld
- Built an adjustable ergonomics jig to measure drivers' preferred pedal positions in X, Y, and Z.
- Cut required frame height by 2 in, saving an estimated 0.8 lb of frame mass. Shortened the moment arm from 10.08 to 6.5 in to reduce bending at the mounting tabs, a recurring failure point.

Proposed Geometry Vertical Vs Horizontal FBD (Side View)



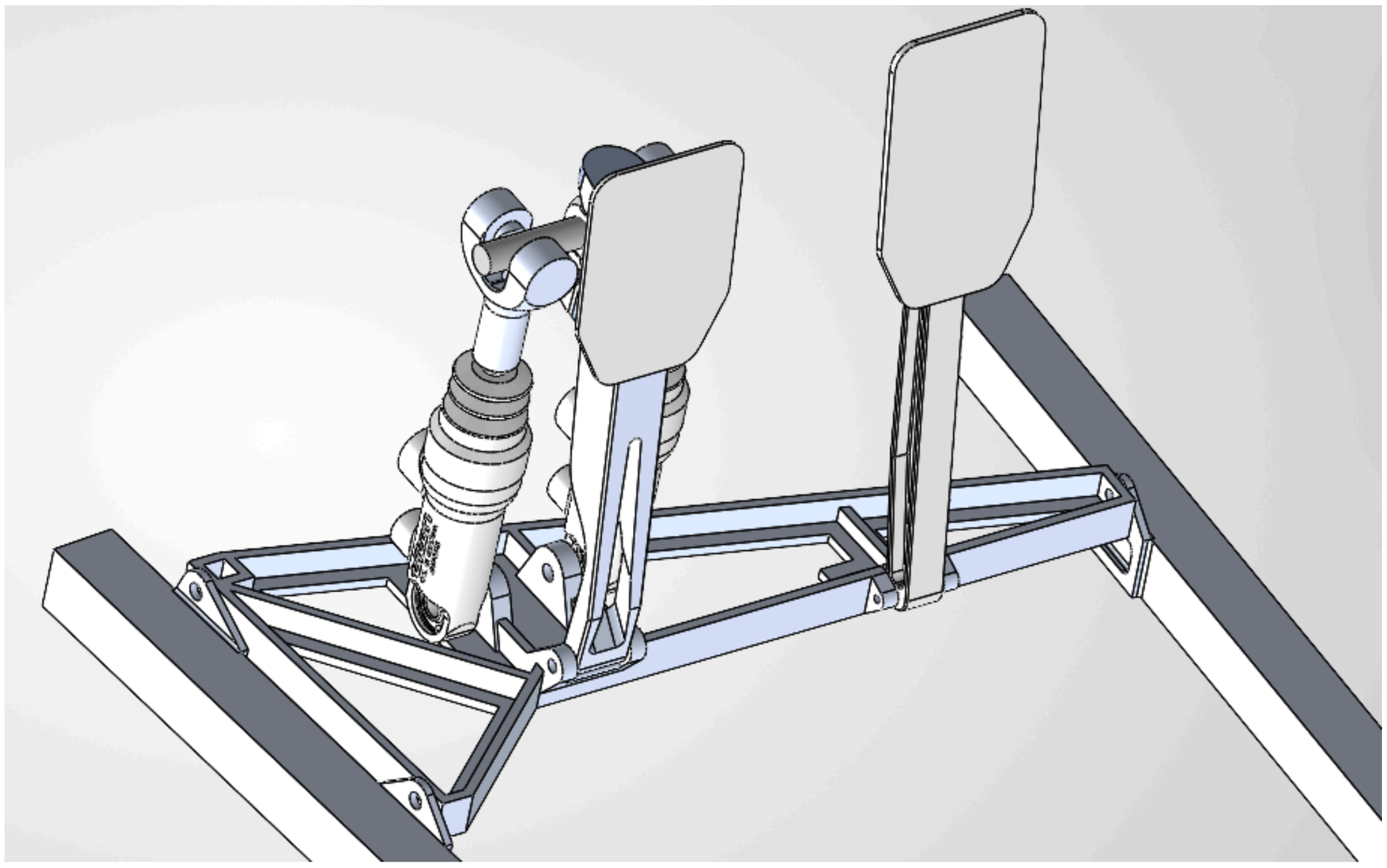
Tab Orientation FBD Comparison



AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

Current Pedal Box CAD



Ergonomics Test Jig





AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

FSAE SUSPENSION DESIGN, SIMULATION & FATIGUE ANALYSIS

Independent Projects | May–Aug 2026

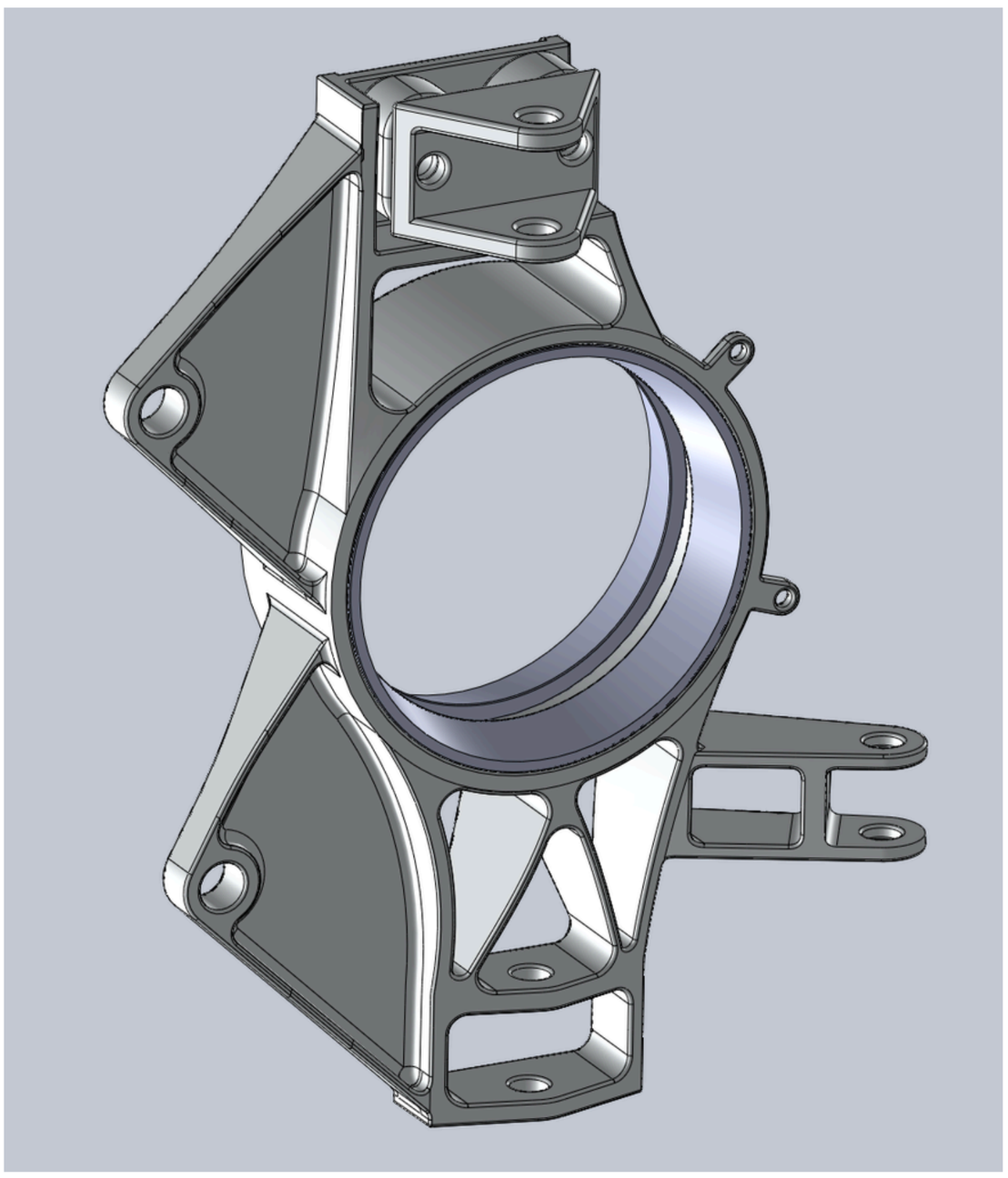
Project Scope: A self-directed project built around the team's real suspension hardpoints, taking on a more complex CAD/FEA problem than my prior work by designing and iterating a billet front upright from scratch. Built a custom data logger to learn the real physics and dynamics of the car firsthand, then applied that real measured data to a rainflow-counting fatigue-life analysis, closing the loop from measured load to calculated stress and estimated fatigue life.

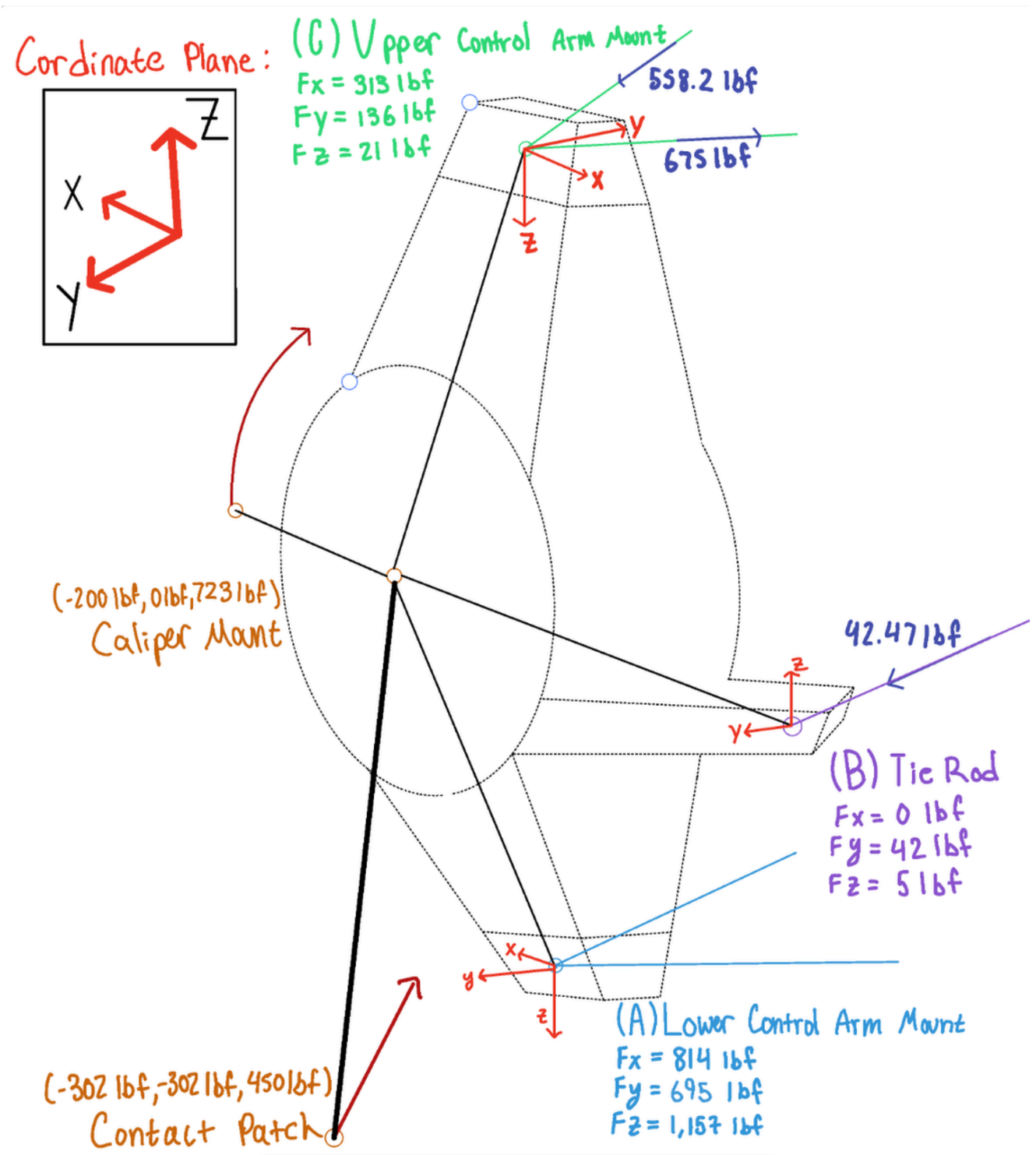
Billet Upright :

- Triangulated ribs around team hardpoints to favor tension/compression load paths and reduce bending
- Diagnosed iteration-1 singularity as a modeling artifact before trusting the result
- Added a ~0.01-lb I-beam caliper-mount rib, reducing predicted deflection 0.020→0.009 in

Iteration	FOS	Max stress	Deflection	Mass
1	—	singularity	0.098 in	0.52 lb
2	1.57	46,496 psi	0.020 in	0.48 lb
3 (final)	1.90	38,387 psi	0.009 in	0.49 lb

Final upright CAD | 0.49 lb

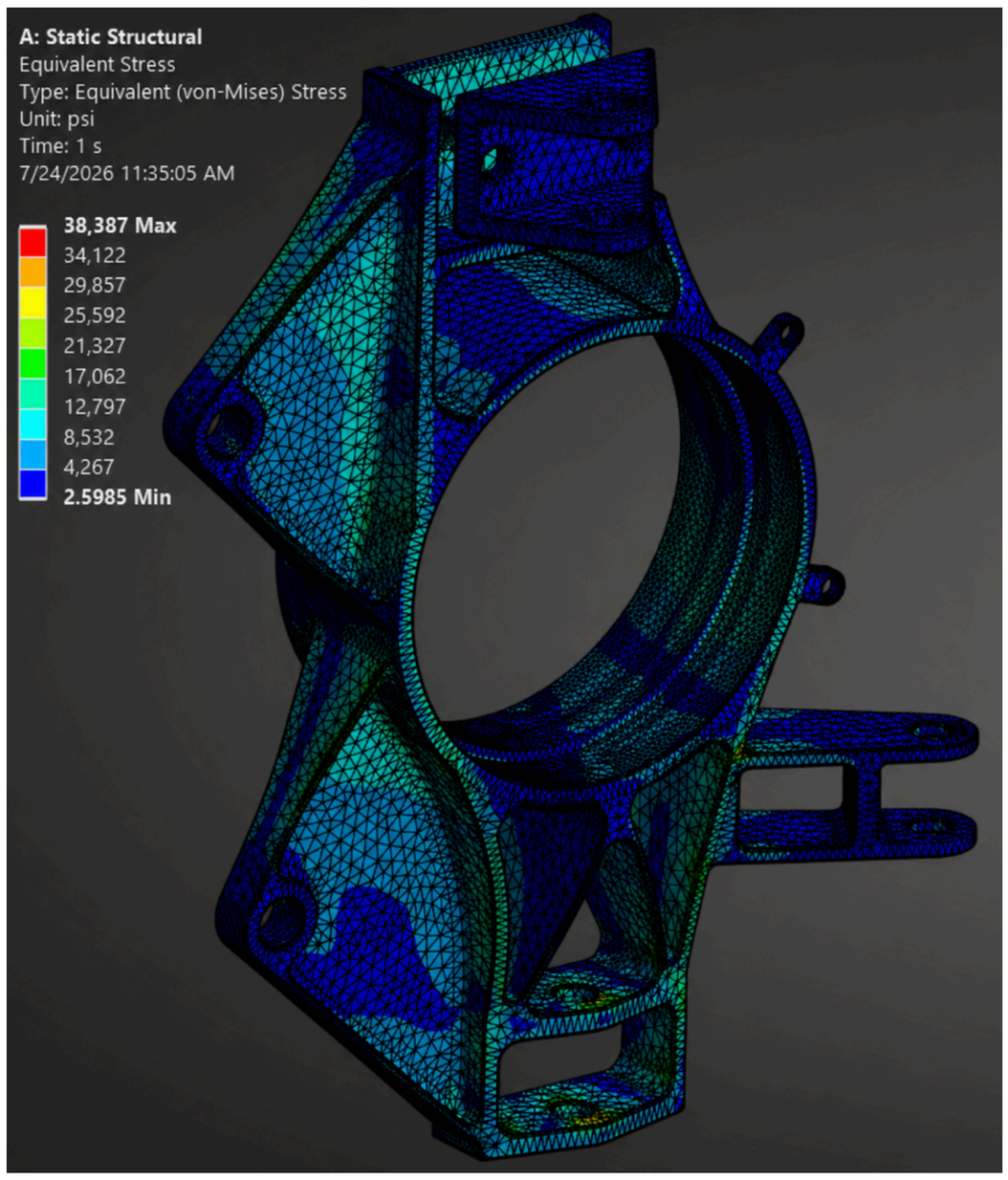




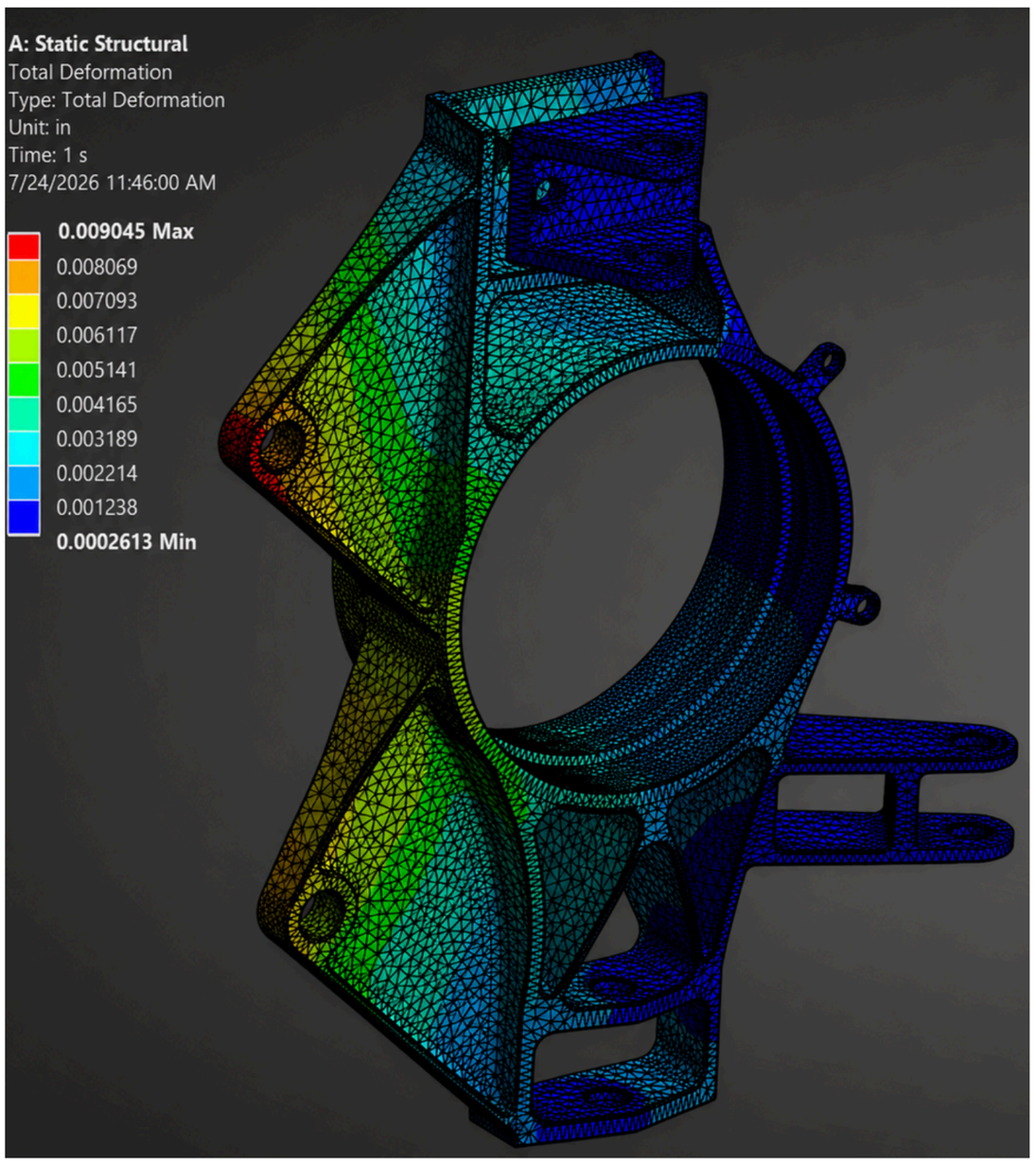
AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

Equivalent stress | 38.4 ksi max

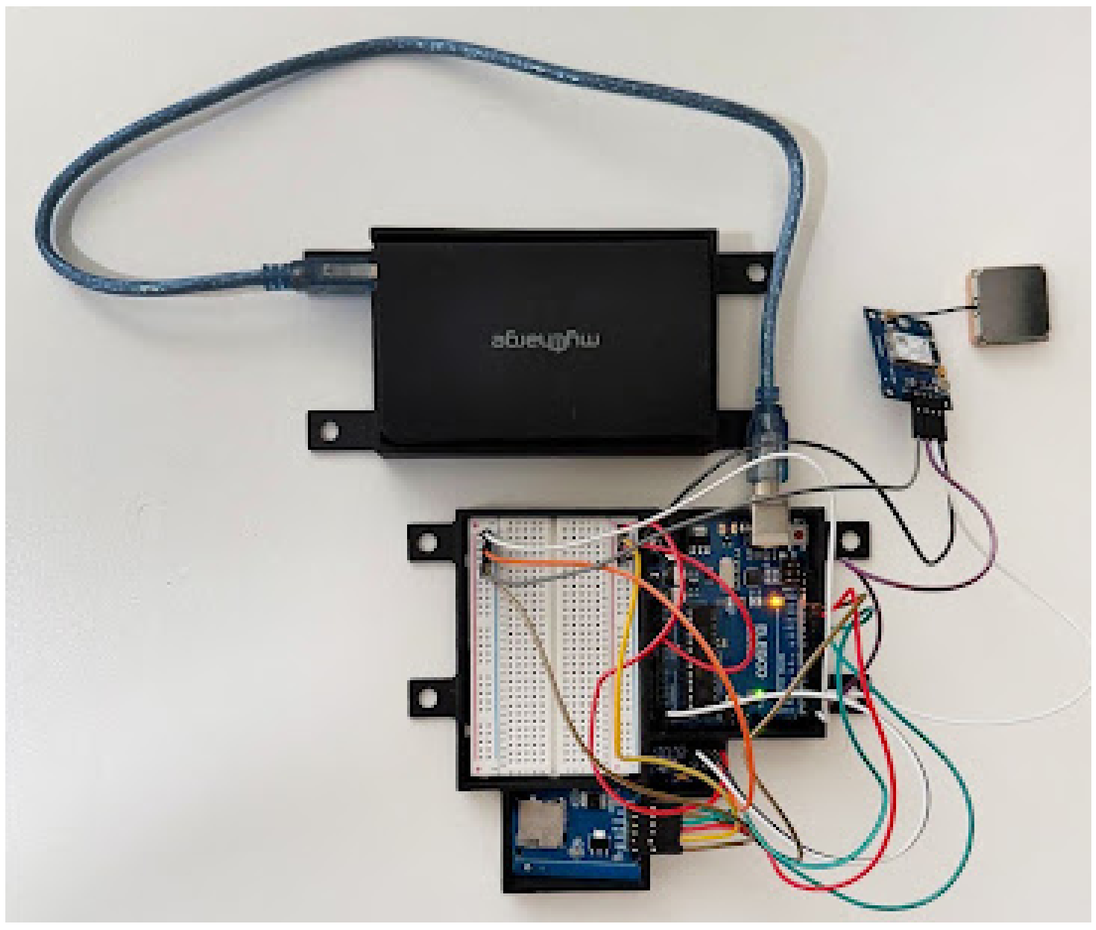


Total deformation | 0.009 in max

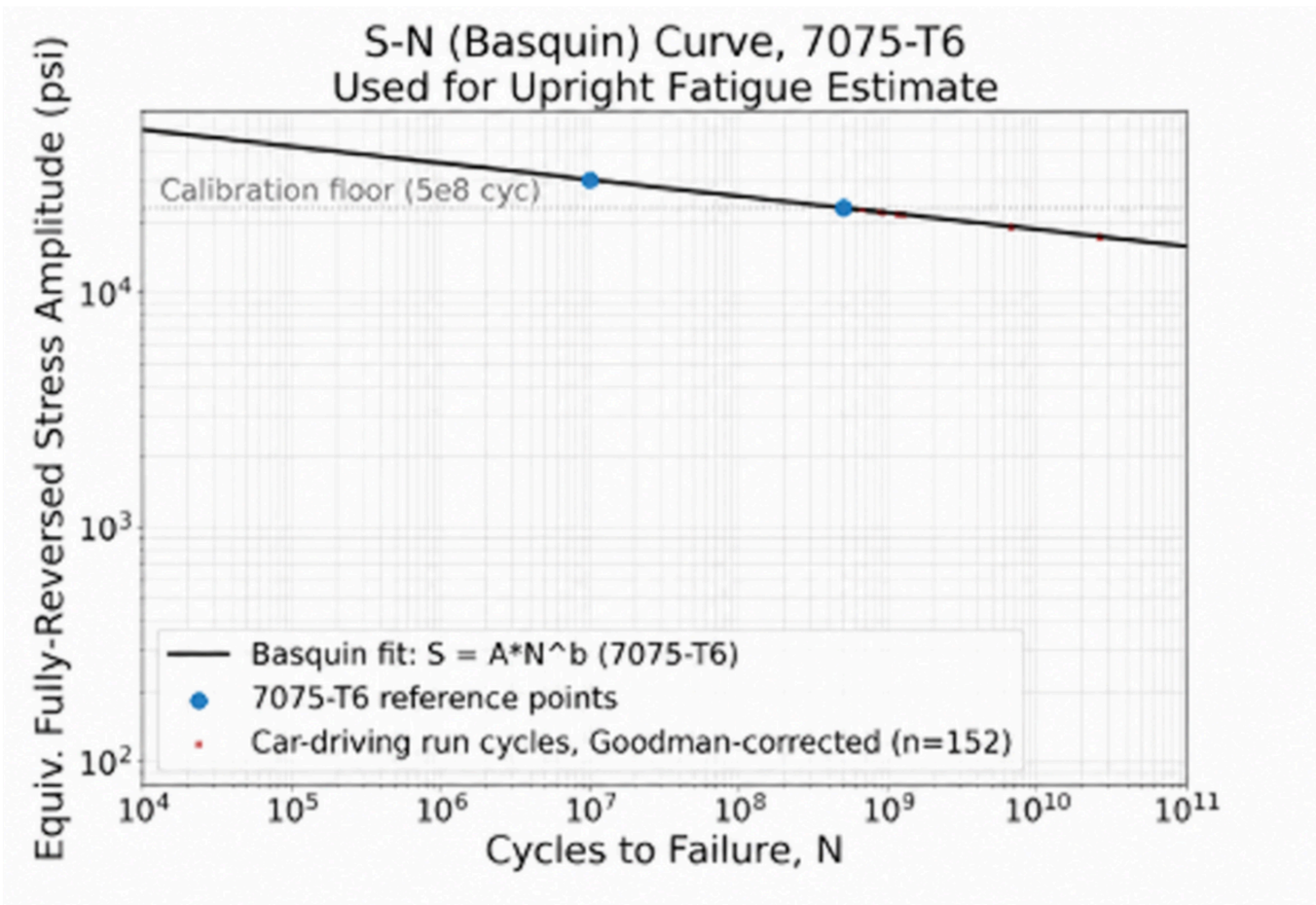


Data Logger and Exploratory Fatigue Analysis:

- Built an Arduino accelerometer/GPS logger with SD storage and collected five logged runs to examine real acceleration histories.
- Rainflow-counted acceleration cycles in Python, estimated stress from one upright FEA load case, and applied Goodman, S–N data, and Miner's rule to estimate fatigue damage.
- Established a working analysis pipeline, not a validated service-life prediction. The stress-per-g scale lacked directional FEA or strain calibration, and roughly 2 Hz logging missed faster loads.



Arduino Data Logger



AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

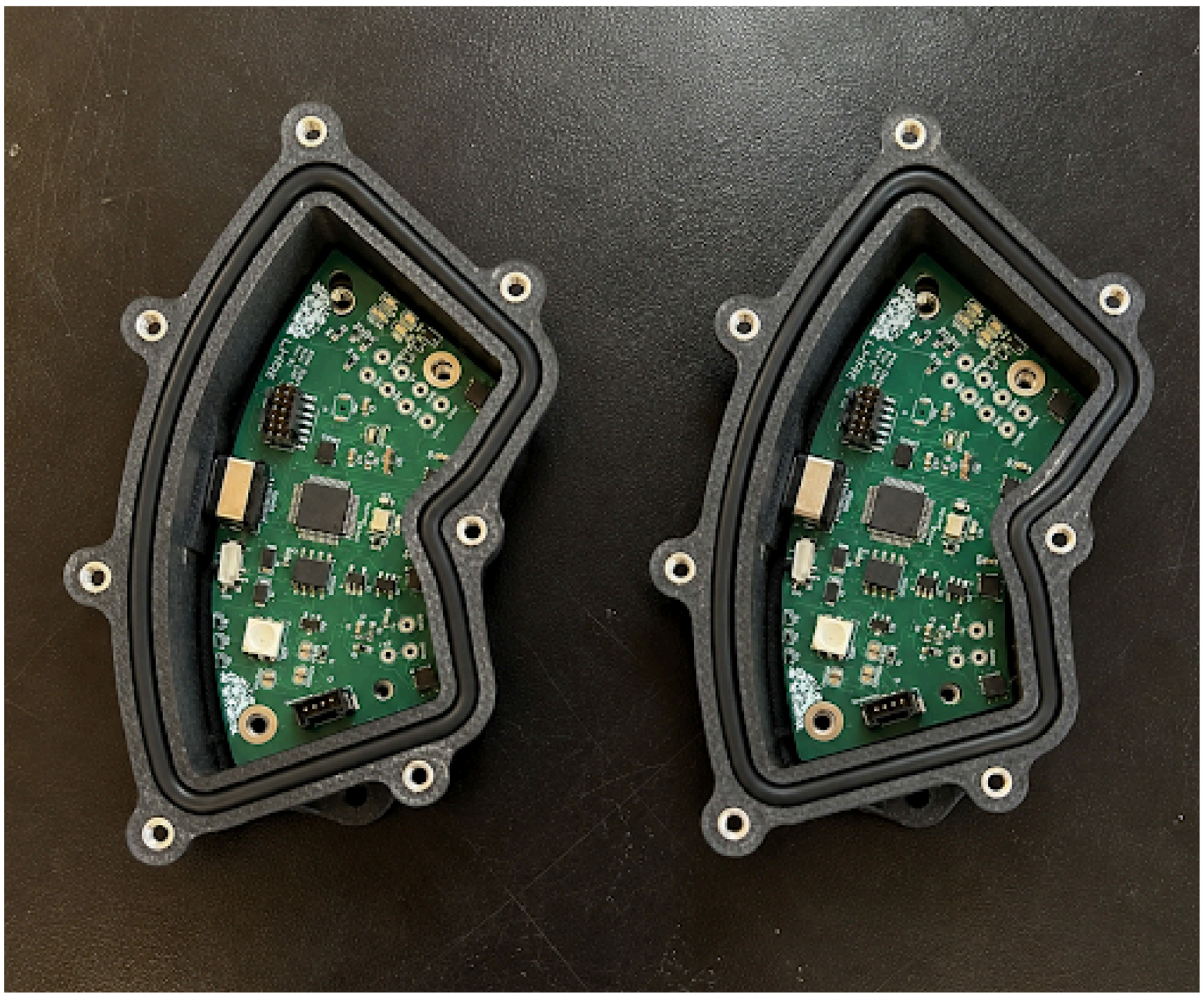
HALL-EFFECT SENSOR ENCLOSURE & MAGNETIC INTEGRATION

Longhorn Racing Electric | Aug 2025–Jan 2026

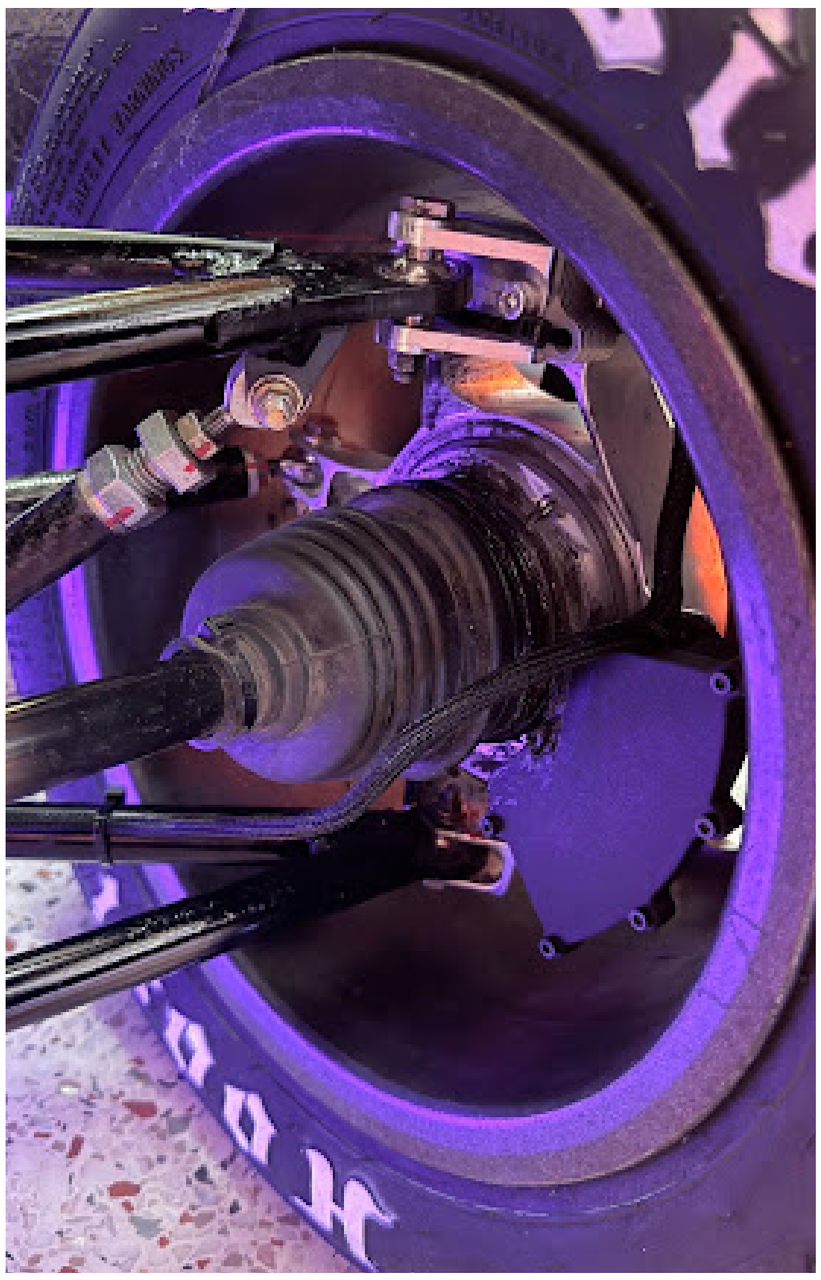
- Sealed PCB enclosure, integrated O-ring grooves, IP67 water-ingress rating in unsprung packaging
- Pivot-and-arcuate-slot PCB mount for fine Hall-effect sensor alignment to rotating magnets
- Magnet strength/placement sized via magnetic flux calc sheet, informing custom-machined magnet-carrying preload nut
- Fastener count and lid thickness tuned alongside O-ring depth; found to affect sealing as much as the O-ring itself

Test	Result
Gland depth trials	1/16 in (failed), 1/8 in, 3/32 in (selected, min footprint)
Immersion test	1 m, 30 min, IP67 criterion, 0 leakage
Signal margin	Magnet strength +20%, reduced angular misalignment

Assembled wheel-speed enclosures



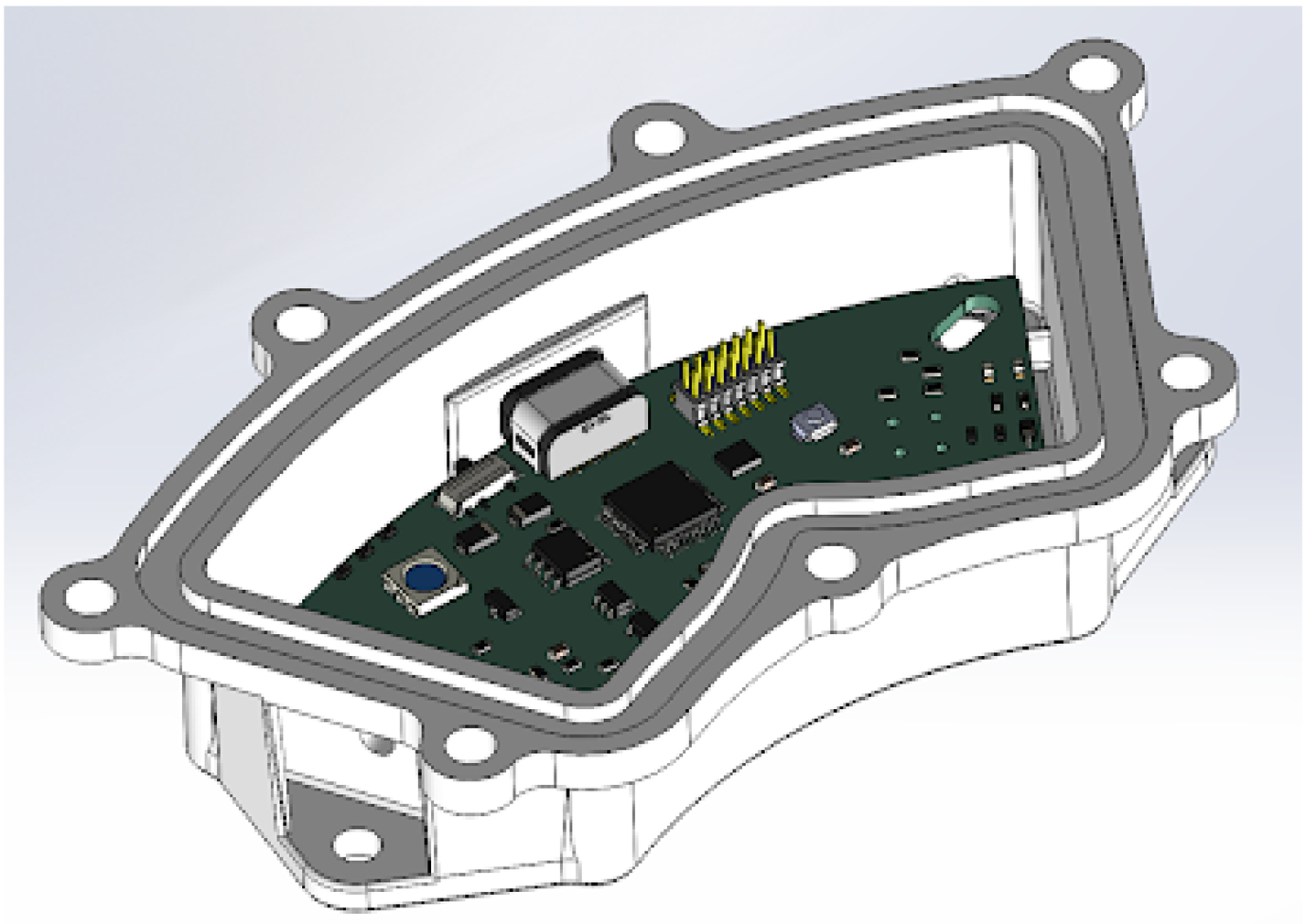
Installed rear-wheel package



AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

Sealed PCB enclosure CAD



Magnet-carrying preload nut



Magnetic Flux Requirement Calculation Sheet

L	W	H	V
0.125	0.25	0.25	0.0078125
			1.28E-07

Description	Variable	Value
Inputs		
Rated Magnetic Flux Density (Gauss)	B_r	12400
Volume of Magnet (m^3)	V	1.28E-07
Magnetic Flux density sensor requirem	β	5
distance from magnet centroid to sens	z	14.7

Outputs		
Magnetic Flux density sensor requirement (G)	β	50
distance from magnet centroid (m)	z	0.0147
Rated magnetic strength product	σ_r	1.59E-03
Magnetic strength product (G*m^3)	σ	0.000998
required distance with given magnet (mm)	z	**17.16**

NASA MODULAR LUNAR FLAGPOLE

NASA Johnson Space Center, ER4 | Jul–Aug 2025

Project Scope: Owned the deployment mechanism, material selection, detailed CAD, prototyping, and physical manufacturing for a modular lunar flagpole designed for tool-free operation by a single astronaut.

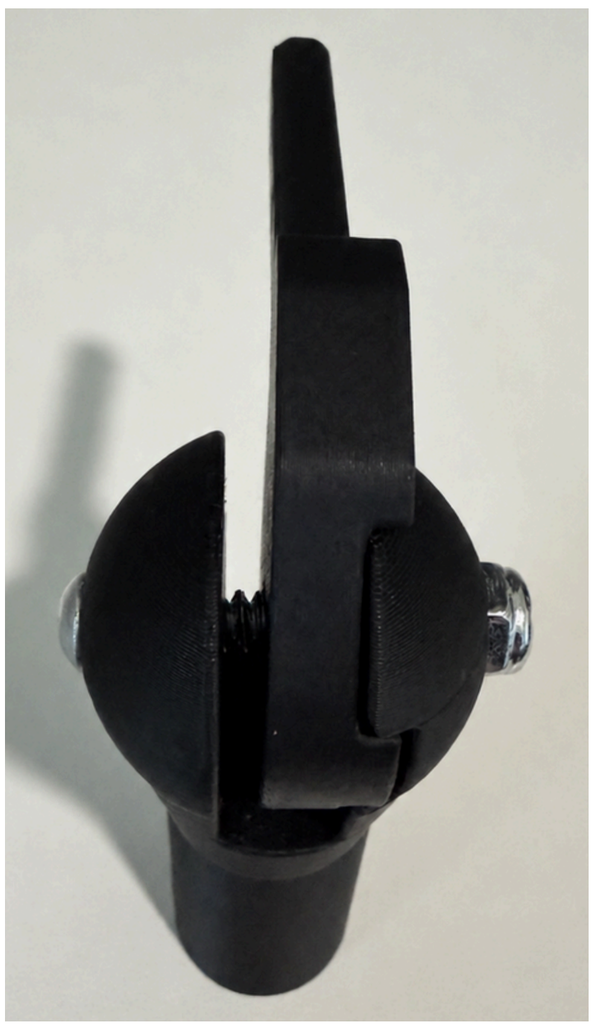
- Spring-loaded clevis pivot joint: single-motion deployment, auto-locks , no tools
- Selected 6061 aluminum over carbon fiber to reduce material-qualification uncertainty and improve machinability, cost, and prototype repeatability
- Governing load case is astronaut handling/assembly force, not wind (no atmosphere present); joint sized for that despite flag self-weight reduced under 1/6g lunar gravity
- Delivered final prototype to NASA JSC ER4 robotics team

AIDEN CHENEY

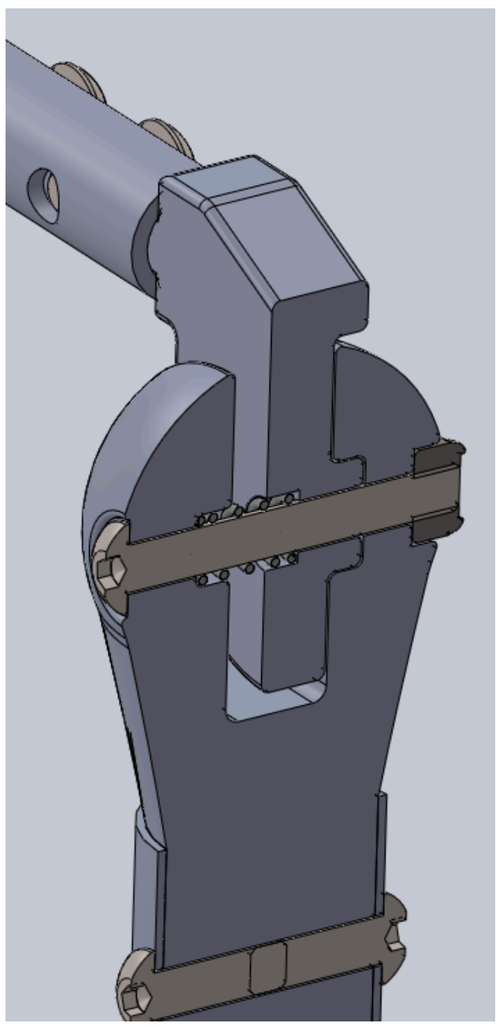
MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

Constraint	Result
Weight	<3 lb
Deployment	60 in, single motion, tool-free
Material	6061 aluminum (vs. carbon fiber)
Validation	Repeated manual deploy/handling cycles, 0 disengagement, 0 permanent deformation

3D Printed Proto



Spring-lock mech



VEX COMPETITION ROBOT SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT

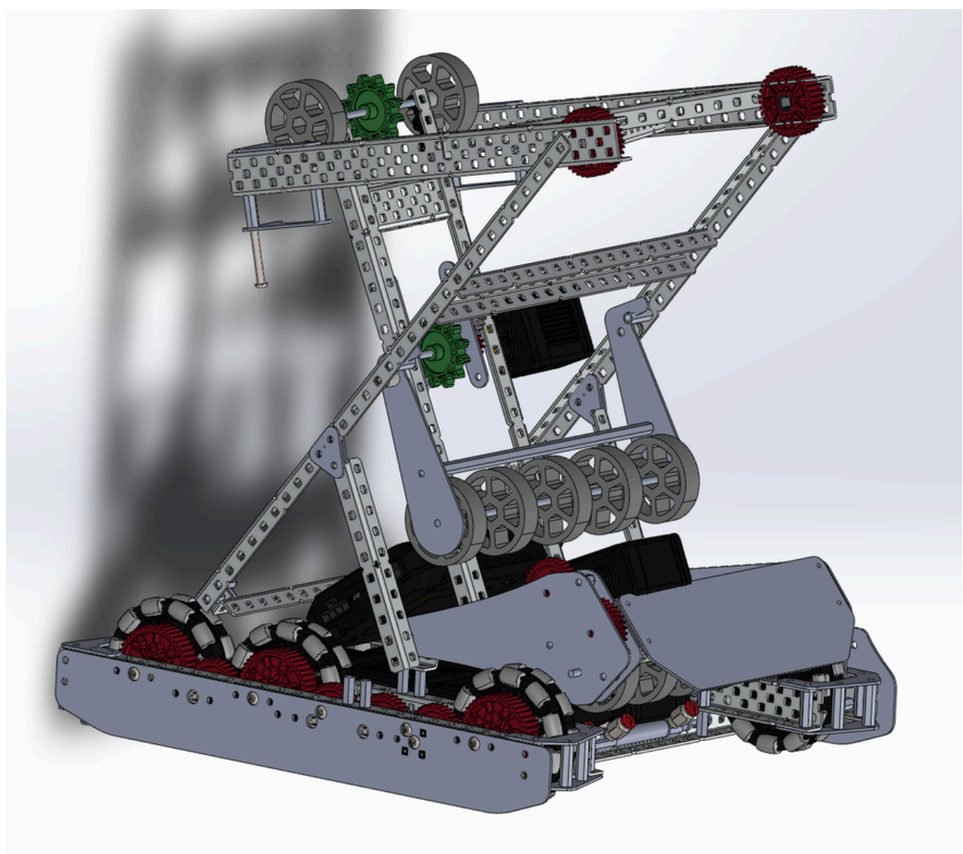
VEX Team 4148Z | Jan–Apr 2024

Project Scope: Owned the complete design and integration of a ring intake/transfer system and a piston-actuated sliding-gear power take-off (PTO) endgame climb mechanism, including CAD, machining, assembly, programming, testing, and competition iteration.

- CNC-machined polycarbonate components load-driven material removal for mass + deflection cut
- Piston-actuated sliding-gear PTO: low backlash drive↔climb shift, no added motor count
- 85% of robot mass packaged in bottom 2 in, improves acceleration, cornering stability, tip resistance

Result	Value
Robot mass	–15%+
Tower Deflection	0.10 → 0.06 in
Subsystem swap time	under 3 min
Shaft/bearing tolerance	±0.002–0.004 in
Chassis mass (bottom 2 in)	>85% of total robot mass

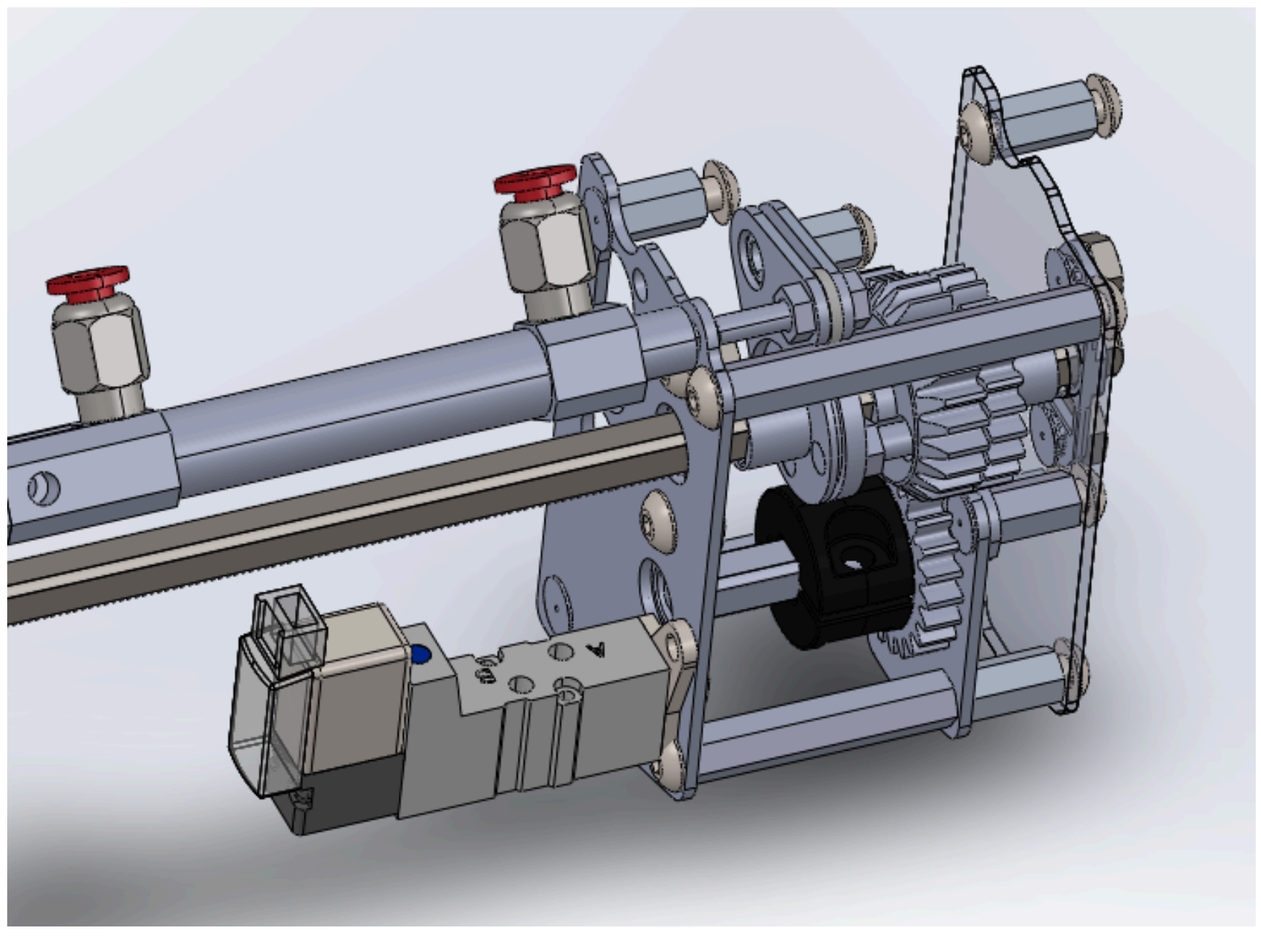
Robot CAD Assembly



AIDEN CHENEY

MECHANICAL ENGINEERING | THE UNIVERSITY OF TEXAS AT AUSTIN

PTO CAD Assembly (Half)



Physical Robot Assembly

